

IIRSM Course Approval — Full Submission Brief

eLearning Application (No Trainer) | Chainsaw Maintenance & Cross Cutting | Ground Level | Version 1.5
Submitted by Overleaf Publishers Ltd | chainsawcourses.com | July 2026

SECTION 1 | Course Identity & Operational Specification

Official Course Title	Chainsaw Maintenance & Cross Cutting (Ground Level Framework)
Course Format	eLearning — Progressive Web Application (PWA) combined with an integrated printed manual; no trainer required
Publisher	Overleaf Publishers Ltd
Course Author / Developer	David J Daniel
Copyright	Copyright © 2026 Overleaf Publishers Ltd. All rights reserved. First Edition: July 2026
Platform URL	chainsawcourses.com
Contact Email	info@chainsawcourses.com
Postal Address	69 Newstead Avenue, Orpington, BR6 9RW
NOS Alignment	Independently mapped to UK National Occupational Standards (NOS) for Chainsaw Operations
NPTC Alignment	Assessment criteria independently mapped to City & Guilds NPTC 0039-20 unit parameters for theoretical reference and CPD purposes only
CPD Points Awarded	5 Verifiable CPD Points
Guided Learning Hours (GLH)	4 Hours — PWA online modules, video content & gated knowledge checks
Directed Online Assessment	2 Hours — formative module quizzes + 45-question randomised multiple-choice final examination
Independent Self-Study	4 Hours — reading The Chainsaw Manual & risk assessment exercises
Total Qualification Time (TQT)	10 Hours total
Minimum Pass Threshold	80% or higher on the summative examination — unlimited resit attempts permitted
Target Learner Profile	Commercial chainsaw operators, forestry workers, arborists, estate and grounds teams, and landscape professionals
Course Version	Version 1.5 — submitted for initial IIRSM eLearning Course Approval (1 course)
Approval Category	New to IIRSM Course Approval — eLearning (no trainer)

IIRSM requires full details of who developed the course and their level of knowledge and skills to do so.

SECTION 2 | Developer & Author Credentials

Author Name	David J Daniel
Role	Course Author, Content Developer & Platform Publisher
Organisation	Overleaf Publishers Ltd
Chainsaw Qualification	City & Guilds NPTC 0039-20 — Chainsaw Maintenance and Cross Cutting (certificated)
First Aid Certification	Current First Aid at Work certificate held
Industry Experience	Over 27 years in the arboricultural and forestry industry. Worked as an arboricultural contract climber for numerous large and small companies throughout this period, gaining extensive hands-on operational experience across a wide range of site conditions and chainsaw applications.
Assessor & Instructor Quals	City & Guilds NPTC Assessor and LANTRA Instructor and Assessor for 8 years — covering practical chainsaw assessment and vocational training delivery to industry standard.
Published Author	Author of 'The Chainsaw Manual' — currently sold as a standalone physical learning aid to various colleges and training providers across the UK. The manual underpins the theoretical content of this eLearning course.
Subject Research	Course content developed with reference to current UK HSE guidance, NPTC 0039-20 unit standards, and the Overleaf Chainsaw Manual (published reference text)
Platform Development	Full-stack eLearning platform designed, developed and operated by author — Progressive Web Application with device-locked access, video streaming, and automated assessment

SECTION 3 | Course Structure & Learning Hours Breakdown

Total Qualification Time (TQT): 10 Hours

Guided Learning (GLH): 4 Hours	PWA online modules, embedded video content, and gated knowledge checks
Directed Assessment: 2 Hours	Formative module quizzes + 45-question randomised multiple-choice final examination
Independent Self-Study: 4 Hours	Reading The Chainsaw Manual & risk assessment exercises
CPD Points Awarded: 5 Verifiable CPD Points	

Course Modules & Content Areas

- Course Requirements — Introduction, digital waiver, PPE requirements, companion manual overview
- Assessment Modules (Standards & Regulations) — Health and Safety at Work Act 1974, PUWER 1998, MHOR 1992, risk assessment methodology (5 steps)
- Chainsaw Maintenance — Safety features, pre-use checks, air filter, spark plug, cooling system, exhaust, fuel & oil systems, recoil starter, sprocket, chain brake, guidebar, chain identification, sharpening techniques, depth gauges
- Cross Cutting — Timber tension & compression, safe working zones, bore cuts, biosecurity, environmental considerations, ergonomics, timber stacking, manual handling
- Final Assessment — 45-question randomised examination drawn from full question bank; 80% pass threshold; unlimited resit attempts
- Practical Gateway — Post-pass progression document signposting learners to NPTC/Lantra approved assessment centres for practical qualification

SECTION 4 | Platform Technical Specification

Platform Type	Progressive Web Application (PWA) — installable on iOS and Android; no app store required
Access Control	Device-locked activation code system — each learner receives a unique code; prevents credential sharing
Video Hosting	Vimeo Pro — encrypted streaming; watermark overlays display learner name and email dynamically
Assessment	Server-side randomised question bank; results stored in PostgreSQL database with full audit trail
Digital Waiver	Touch/mouse signature capture on first login — legally binding acknowledgement of course terms
Certificates	Automated PDF certificate issued on passing the final examination — emailed to learner; also saved to secure cloud storage
Data Security	All data encrypted in transit (TLS 1.3); hosted on Replit deployment infrastructure (EU region)
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA compliant colour contrast; keyboard navigable; screen-reader compatible markup
Browser Support	Chrome 120+, Safari 16+, Firefox 120+, Edge 120+
Companion Manual	Overleaf Chainsaw Manual (printed) — supplied separately; referenced throughout the digital course

SECTION 5 | Quality Assurance & Review Process

Content accuracy is assured through the following quality control measures:

- All module content cross-referenced against current HSE Chainsaw guidance (HSE AFAG series) and City & Guilds NPTC 0039-20 unit specifications.
- Quiz questions reviewed by the author against published assessment criteria and common examiner focus areas.
- Platform functionality tested across all supported browsers and device types prior to launch.
- Annual content review scheduled — first review due July 2027.
- Learner feedback captured post-examination and monitored for accuracy and relevance signals.
- Any changes to UK legislation or HSE guidance will trigger an unscheduled content review within 30 days of publication.
- GLH and TQT figures are conservative and verifiable: 4 hours GLH reflects the actual platform module time; 4 hours independent self-study reflects engagement with the printed Chainsaw Manual; 2 hours directed assessment reflects formative quizzes plus the 45-question final examination.